

WILLIAM RAYO, PH.D.

Curriculum Vitae

CONTACT

✉ wrayo@ucdavis.edu

🌐 rayowilliam.com

🆔 0000-0002-8540-5212

Updated October 2026

POSITIONS AND APPOINTMENTS

Current
|
2025

- **Assistant Professor of Teaching**
Department of Psychology, University of California, Davis

EDUCATION

Jun 2025

- **Ph.D., Psychology**
Oregon State University

Jun 2022

- **M.S., Psychology**
Oregon State University

Dec 2014

- **M.A.T., Secondary Social Science Education**
University of South Florida

May 2013

- **B.A., Psychology**
University of South Florida

INTERESTS

- Scholarship of Teaching and Learning
- Network Psychometrics
- Large Language Models
- Individual Differences
- Socially infused approach to Bilingualism, Cognition, and Culture

AWARDS AND HONORS

2026

- **Small Grant in Aid of Research, Creative Activities, and Scholarship**
University of California, Davis, \$2,000
 - Project: *Learning Technical Skills in a Non-Major Context: Teaching and Learning in Data Visualization for the Social Sciences*

2026

- **Teaching Innovation Grant (not funded)**
University of California, Davis, \$25,000
 - With Drs. Jonathan J. Park and Victoria Cross, to modernize the curriculum of PSC 012Y: Data Visualization in the Social Sciences

2024

- **COGDOP Graduate Research Scholarship**
American Psychological Foundation, \$2,000

- 2024 ● **Researcher Access Program**
OpenAI, \$2,500
- 2024 ● **Scholarly Presentation Award**
Oregon State University
- 2024 ● **E-Campus Travel Award**
Oregon State University, \$2,400
- 2024 ● **Graduate Student Travel Grant**
Society for the Teaching of Psychology (APA Division 2), \$750
- 2023 ● **Remote Access Modality (RAM) Pilot Project**
Oregon State University, \$500
- 2023 ● **Graduate Student Travel Grant**
Society for the Teaching of Psychology (APA Division 2), \$1,250
- 2022 ● **Lumen Circles Success Accelerator for Waymaker Fellowship Grant**
Lumen Learning, \$500
- 2019 ● **Chaparral Champion Award**
Westlake High School
- 2018 ● **Clark University Workshop for High School Teachers**
American Psychological Association
- 2018 ● **Golden Apple – Student Appreciation Award**
Westlake High School
- 2015 ● **Graduate School Travel Award**
University of South Florida
- 2014 ● **Outstanding Latino/a Educator Award (OLÉ)**
University of South Florida College of Education, \$500
- 2014 ● **Graduate School Travel Award**
University of South Florida



TEACHING EXPERIENCE: INSTRUCTOR OF RECORD

- 2027 ● **PSC 135: Science of the Mind**
Instructor and Coordinator, UC Davis Global Learning Program 📍 University of Bologna
• Scheduled for 2027
- 2026 ● **PSC 001: General Psychology** 📍 UC Davis
|
2025
• Fall 2026: 500 students
• Spring 2026: 416 students
• Winter 2026: 500 students
• Fall 2025: 430 students

2026	● PSC 001V: General Psychology (Virtual) • Summer II 2026: 150 students	📍 UC Davis
2026	● PSC 190: Seminar in Psychology • Fall 2026: 15 students	📍 UC Davis
2026	● PSC 012Y: Data Visualization • Spring 2026: 50 students • Winter 2026: 100 students	📍 UC Davis

GRADUATE TEACHING EXPERIENCE

2025 2024	● PSY 297: Thinking like a Psychological Scientist Graduate Instructor of Record • Spring 2025: 50 students • Winter 2025: 50 students • Fall 2024: 50 students	📍 Oregon State University
2025 2023	● PSY 311: Careers in Psychology Graduate Teaching Assistant • Spring 2025: 100 students • Winter 2025: 100 students • Fall 2024: 100 students • Spring 2024: 100 students • Winter 2024: 100 students • Fall 2023: 100 students	📍 Oregon State University
2024 2023	● PSY 297: Thinking like a Psychological Scientist Graduate Teaching Assistant • Spring 2024: 100 students • Winter 2024: 100 students • Fall 2023: 100 students	📍 Oregon State University
2023 2022	● PSY 201: Introductory Psychology Graduate Instructor of Record • Spring 2023: 50 students • Fall 2022: 25 students (EOP) • Spring 2022: 25 students (EOP)	📍 Oregon State University
2023 2021	● PSY 202: Introductory Psychology Graduate Instructor of Record • Winter 2023: 25 students (EOP) • Winter 2022: 25 students (EOP) • Fall 2021: 25 students (EOP) • Spring 2021: 50 students • Winter 2021: 50 students	📍 Oregon State University
2020	● PSY 202: Introductory Psychology Graduate Teaching Assistant • Fall 2020: 300 students	📍 Oregon State University

SECONDARY TEACHING

2020
|
2017

- **Advanced Placement (AP) Psychology**
Secondary Educator  Westlake High School

Taught 4 sections of AP Psychology per year, fostering student understanding of key psychological concepts, research methods, and real-world applications.

- 2019–2020: 4 sections, 37 students per class
- 2018–2019: 4 sections, 37 students per class
- 2017–2018: 4 sections, 37 students per class

2020
|
2018

- **Advanced Placement (AP) Research**
Secondary Educator  Westlake High School

Designed and taught the AP Research course, guiding students through independent research projects, critical analysis, and academic writing.

- 2019–2020: 8 students
- 2018–2019: 10 students

MENTORSHIP

2026
|
2025

- **Undergraduate Thesis Committee Member**
University of California, Davis
 - Asia-Jae Davis (2025–2026); project presented as a poster at the Western Psychological Association Convention (2026)

2026
|
2025

- **Graduate Student Research Mentorship**
University of California, Davis
 - Sabrina Karjack (2025–2026); SoTL research project presented as a poster at the Society for the Teaching of Psychology's Annual Conference on Teaching (2026)

PUBLICATIONS

** denotes student author*

2026

- **Bilingualism in Context: A Bayesian Psychometric Network Analysis of Language and Culture Among U.S. Heritage Spanish–English Speakers of Latin American Descent**
Rayo, W., & Carbajal, I. *Behavioral Sciences*, 16(4), 522.

2025

- **Racial literacy development: The efficacy of a face-to-face and an online course on race and racism**
Carbajal, I., **Rayo, W.**, & Khan, R.* [White Paper]. Oregon State University Ecampus Research Unit.

2024

- **The Complexity in Bilingual Code-Switching Research: A Systematic Review**
Rayo, W., Barrita, A. M., Cabrera Martinez, L., & Carbajal, I. *Languages*, 9(6), Article 6.

PRESENTATIONS

** denotes student author*

2026

- **Anxiety, Enjoyment, Self-Concept: What Changes When Non-Majors Code?**
Rayo, W. [Symposium Presentation]. Society for the Teaching of Psychology's Annual Conference on Teaching. St. Louis, MO.

- 2024 ● **Entre Nombres y Sentimientos: Using LLM's to explore Sentiments Behind identity labels in the Latin American Diaspora**
Rayo, W., Cabrera-Martinez, L., & Carbajal, I. [Symposium Presentation]. National Latinx Psychological Association. San Juan, PR.
- 2024 ● **From Awareness to Action: Teaching Racial Literacy in Diverse Modalities**
Rayo, W., Hunt, K., Khan, R.*, & Carbajal, I. 25-minute symposium at Society for the Teaching of Psychology's Annual Conference on Teaching. Louisville, KY.
- 2024 ● **Integrating AI into the Classroom: Novel Assignment Types and Collaborative Insights**
Slade, J., & Rayo, W. [Talk]. Society for the Teaching of Psychology's Annual Conference on Teaching. Louisville, KY.
- 2023 ● **Cultivating Community and Belongingness: An Experiential Approach to Enhancing Engagement in the "Thinking Like a Psychological Scientist" Course**
Rayo, W., & Carbajal, I. 25-minute symposium at Society for the Teaching of Psychology's Annual Conference on Teaching. Portland, OR.
- 2023 ● **Talking about race: Pedagogy in a psychology of race and racism course**
Carbajal, I., & Rayo, W. [Talk]. Society for the Teaching of Psychology's Annual Conference on Teaching. Portland, OR.
- 2023 ● **Latent Profile Analyses and Intersectionality**
Carbajal, I., Cabrera-Martinez, L., & Rayo, W. [Symposium Presentation]. APA Division 45 Annual Conference. San Diego, CA.
- 2021 ● **Weathering the Storm, Remotely**
Stone, A., & Rayo, W. Flash talk at the 2021 Association for Psychological Science Virtual Convention.
- 2015 ● **Social Studies for ELLs: Engaging Strategies for all Students**
Rayo, W., Rosenberg, G., & Maag, E. 50-minute session presented at the National Conference for the Social Studies. New Orleans, LA.
- 2014 ● **Effective Social Studies Instructional Strategies for English Language Learners**
Rayo, W., Rosenberg, G., Maag, E., Ortega, O., & Falls, T. 50-minute session presented at the Florida Conference for the Social Studies. Orlando, FL.

POSTER PRESENTATIONS

** denotes student author*

- 2026 ● **Evaluating the Influence of "Science of Learning" Instruction on Student Study Habits**
Karjack, S.*, Rayo, W., & Cross, V. Poster presentation at Society for the Teaching of Psychology's Annual Conference on Teaching. St. Louis, MO.
- 2024 ● **Too Much of a Good Thing? Balancing Instructional Aids for Optimal Learning**
Rayo, W., Quaglino, E.*, & Becker-Blease, K. Poster presentation at Society for the Teaching of Psychology's Annual Conference on Teaching. Louisville, KY.
- 2023 ● **Decoding Bilingualism: A Network Psychometrics Perspective on Cognition and Culture**
Rayo, W., Nieto, P.*, & Carbajal, I. Poster presentation at the Annual Meeting of the Psychonomic Society. San Francisco, CA.
- 2023 ● **Modeling Diverse Bilingual Experiences: A Network Model Approach**
Rayo, W., & Carbajal, I. Poster presentation at the National Latinx Psychological Association. Chicago, IL.

- 2023 ● **Insights from teaching a synchronous remote general psychology pilot course after students are back to F2F instruction**
Rayo, W., & Tran, S. Poster presentation at Society for the Teaching of Psychology's Annual Conference on Teaching. Portland, OR.
- 2023 ● **Racial Microaggressions, Critical Consciousness, and Psychological Distress: Latent Profile Approach**
Cabrera Martinez, L., Rayo, W., & Carbajal, I. Poster presentation at the APA Division 45 Research Conference. San Diego, CA.
- 2023 ● **Multi-Identity Influences on Microaggressions, Critical Consciousness, and Mental Health**
Cabrera-Martinez, L., Barrita, A., Rayo, W., & Carbajal, I. [Poster Presentation]. 2023 APA Division 45 Annual Conference. San Diego, CA.
- 2023 ● **Obstacles and Barriers Latinx Students Face in the Pursuit of Higher Education**
Salamanca, L.*, Rayo, W., & Carbajal, I. Poster presentation at the Western Psychological Association Convention.
- 2022 ● **Adding a diversity and inclusion statement is not enough! The effect of syllabus tone and students' racial identity on the efficacy of diversity and inclusion statements**
Rayo, W., & Becker-Blease, K. Poster presentation at the Western Psychological Association Convention. Portland, OR.
- 2021 ● **Is Adding a Diversity Statement Enough? The Role of Syllabus Tone on Diversity Statements in Student Perceptions of Instructors**
Rayo, W., & Becker-Blease, K. Poster presentation at the Association for Psychological Science Virtual Convention.

INVITED TALKS, GUEST LECTURES, AND WORKSHOPS

- Mar 2026 ● **Active Learning Strategies Workshop**
Departmental Retreat on Undergraduate Education, Department of Psychology, University of California, Davis
 - Led a workshop on embedding active learning into traditional lecture courses: retrieval practice, open-ended prompts, real-world connections, and formative assessment that separates judgments of learning from demonstrated understanding
- Feb 2026 ● **Accessibility Workshop: WCAG 2.1 Level AA**
Faculty workshop with Dr. Victoria Cross, Department of Psychology, University of California, Davis
 - Designed and led a workshop on ADA Title II and Section 504 compliance: what the standard requires, triage guidelines for existing course materials, and remediation tools available through campus and outside vendors
- Jul 2024 ● **STP Early Career Psychology Hackathon**
APA Division 2: Society for the Teaching of Psychology
 - Professional development experience for early career psychology professionals to network with other ECPs to discuss and share resources. Assisted in facilitating two 45-minute roundtable discussions on:
 - Utilizing AI in the classroom
 - Instructional methodology in the Introduction to Psychology course

- Jun 2024

- **2024 Oregon State University High School Teacher's Workshop**
 American Psychological Association / Oregon State University's School of Psychological Science
 - Professional development experience for high school psychology teachers to listen to faculty research presentations, opportunity to share peer-to-peer creative ideas and learn new concepts to enhance teaching skills further. Assisted in facilitating discussions on:
 - Conducting/incorporating research into the psychology classroom
 - Diversifying the psychology curriculum
 - Utilizing AI to prompt metacognition in the classroom
- Winter 2024

- **Cultural Psycholinguistics**
 Guest lecture, Introductory Psychology, Oregon State University
- Oct 2023

- **Invited Panelist, "Accelerating Your Research Using AI"**
 Oregon State University
 - Engaged as a panelist in a multidisciplinary discussion on the use of Large Language Models and other AI tools.
 - Explored applications of AI in understanding and summarizing research papers, coding for data analysis, and processing and visualizing large datasets.
 - Event sponsored by Academic Affairs, the Graduate School, and the Research Office at Oregon State University.
- Fall 2023

- **Psychology of Language**
 Guest lecture, Introductory Psychology, Oregon State University
- Spring 2023

- **Scholarship of Teaching and Learning**
 Guest lecture, Introductory Psychology, Oregon State University
- Winter 2023

- **Effective Study Strategies for Psychology and Beyond**
 Guest lecture, Introductory Psychology, Oregon State University
- Sep 2021

- **Invited Panelist, "Getting Real" Graduate Teaching Assistant Orientation**
 Oregon State University
 - Engaged as a panelist discussing the transition to academia as a first generation student, roles and responsibilities for incoming graduate students, and sharing advice on how to successfully transition into their new roles.
- 2019
|
2017

- **District Professional Development Workshops**
 Eanes Independent School District
 - Developed and presented workshops for teachers across the campus and district for professional development:
 - Making student learning stick (2017)
 - Psychology across the social studies (2018)
 - Student learning and retrieval practice (2019)

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

- Jan 2025
|
Sep 2022

- **Steering Committee Member, Graduate Student Teaching Association (GSTA)**
 APA Division 2: Society for the Teaching of Psychology
- 2022

- **Ad Hoc Reviewer**
 PLOS ONE

UNIVERSITY AND SCHOOL SERVICE

- Current
|
2025
- **Instructional Support and Innovation Committee**
Department of Psychology, University of California, Davis
- Current
|
2025
- **Articulation and Equivalency Reviewer, PSC 001: General Psychology**
Department of Psychology, University of California, Davis
- Spring 2023
- **Remote Access Modality (RAM) Pilot Program**
Oregon State University
- 2020
|
2016
- **Teacher Innovation Academy: Founding Member**
Eanes Independent School District
 - Established and secured campus/district funding and support for a cross-disciplinary peer learning community, enabling educators to exchange innovative ideas, collaboratively develop and facilitate professional development sessions, and provide constructive feedback on ongoing projects.
- 2020
|
2016
- **Challenge Success: Member**
Eanes Independent School District
 - Aimed to redefine the perceptions of success in education and promote student well-being and engagement with learning. Worked with various stakeholders (schools, families, and communities) to implement research-based strategies that encourage broad educational values, foster meaningful learning experiences, and maintain a healthy, balanced lifestyle for students.
- 2019
- **Digital Learning Task Force**
Eanes Independent School District
 - Served on an exploratory committee to guide the district-wide implementation of instructional technology. Collaborated with community stakeholders through interviews, forums, and focus groups involving students, teachers, parents, and edtech providers to assess technology needs and applications. Developed strategic recommendations for the effective allocation of district funds to enhance educational outcomes.

CERTIFICATIONS AND SPECIALIZED TRAINING

- 2024
- **Machine Learning**
Statistical Horizons
- 2023
- **Science Training Session: Technical Foundations of Generative Artificial Intelligence, Applications to Measurement**
American Psychological Association (APA)
- 2023
- **Using Large Language Transformer Models for Research in R**
Code Horizons
- 2023
- **Introduction to Artificial Intelligence for Psychological Scientists**
American Psychological Association (APA)
- 2023
- **Best Practices in Hybrid and Remote Instructional Design**
Center for Teaching and Learning, Oregon State University
- 2022
- **Certificate of Effective Teaching**
Lumen Circles Success Accelerator for Waymaker Fellowship

- 2019 ● **Challenge Success Conference & Workshops**
Sponsored by Stanford University
- 2018 ● **AP Research Certification**
- 2017 ● **AP Psychology Certification**

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Data Analytics:** Data Cleaning, Manipulation, Visualization, Scraping
- **Statistical Analysis:** Descriptive and Inferential Statistics, Bayesian Methods, Psychometric Network Analysis, Exploratory Graph Analysis, Latent Profile Analysis, Exploratory and Confirmatory Factor Analysis, Principal Component Analysis
- **Experimental Design:** Behavioral, Psychophysiological (EEG/ERP), Survey Methods, A/B Testing, Sampling Methodology, Test and Measure Development, Psychometrics
- **Machine Learning:** Classification, Regression, Clustering, Natural Language Processing (Topic Modeling, Sentiment Analysis), Large Language Models, Dimensionality Reduction
- **Pedagogy:** Instructional Design, Test and Measure Design, Measure Evaluation
- **Programming Languages:** R, Python
- **Data Analysis:** RStudio, JASP, Excel
- **Software:** E-Prime, PsychoPy, jsPsych
- **Survey Design:** Qualtrics, Google Forms

ORGANIZATION AFFILIATIONS

- National Latinx Psychological Association
- Society for the Teaching of Psychology
- Psychonomic Society
- SPARK Society
- American Psychological Association
- Association for Psychological Science